

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Paige Turner

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



Paige Turner

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## *Investigative Arts Journalist*

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Her journalistic integrity is unmatched. Paige covers the art world for the Times of Tulsa the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees to keep silent.

- Keeps asking **Barb Dwyer** for access to museum records. **Barb** keeps asking what the story is about.
- **Sue Venir** has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.
- Calls **Reed DeLabel** to check dates and catalogue references. **Reed** is delighted when a correction makes it into print.

## ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

## YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Paige Turner. I am covering the gala. I just want to say in advance that absolutely nothing is off the record tonight.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

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Paige Turner

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

### Your other secret

You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

### Conversations to start

- Find out whether Grant found the full provenance spreadsheet or only excerpts.
- Keep your source's identity protected.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.*

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

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# The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *A green lamp cannot testify, but something near it can.*
- 2 *The house has its own cinema. Inspect the side the audience never sees.*
- 3 *A decorative vessel has traded its bouquet for evidence.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

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## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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Paige Turner

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# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

Grant threatened an injunction and promised to expose my museum source. The documents concern his collection and his labor empire. I obtained them without his permission, which is generally how reporting works when the subject would prefer an invitation to approve the questions. I was protecting a person, not a flattering profile.

## IF MURDERER

He threatened an injunction and my source's identity. I had internal documents, a publication date and somebody inside the museum who could lose their livelihood. Grant enjoyed saying their name quietly enough that nobody else could hear. He expected me to trade the investigation for their safety.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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Paige Turner

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I left the advance programme with the press papers, then went into the recording booth to question my source. I did not put their name in my notes. When I came out, Grant was preparing the private toast. I wanted one more document before his speech, and I was prepared to make him dislike the question.

#### IF MURDERER

I listened to a recorded source interview while moving through the gallery. I had asked Grant for the missing ownership document earlier. Before the toast I checked the file against my notes and put the phone away. He wanted a source's name. I wanted the source to survive publication with a job.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

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# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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Paige Turner

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# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

I called the source Moth in the live booth interview. Its raw record runs from 6:39 to 6:45. I burned the identifying name slip in the metal dish on camera; the documents survive. Source protection can look like evidence destruction. In this instance it was both. The raw interview survives on the source's separate recorder too.

## IF MURDERER

Moth was the name I used in the recorded interview. I destroyed the identifying slip and retained the documents. Grant knew there was somebody inside the museum helping me. He wanted their name exchanged for permission to publish. My notes include the questions I intended to ask and none of the permission he intended to require.

*The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Paige Turner

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## Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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Paige Turner

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## The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I destroyed the slip identifying my source. The uncut booth recording shows that act and my continued interview through the contamination interval. Moth's copy supplies an independent check. The injunction threat was serious; so was the story. I protected the source and preserved the documents. I did not poison Grant.

### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I played the earlier interview while I went to the salon. The folder and covered notes helped me pass as somebody pursuing a story. I took the toxin from preparation supplies and wiped his coupe with museum linen. I wanted my source safe and Grant unable to stop publication. I killed the subject of my own investigation.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*